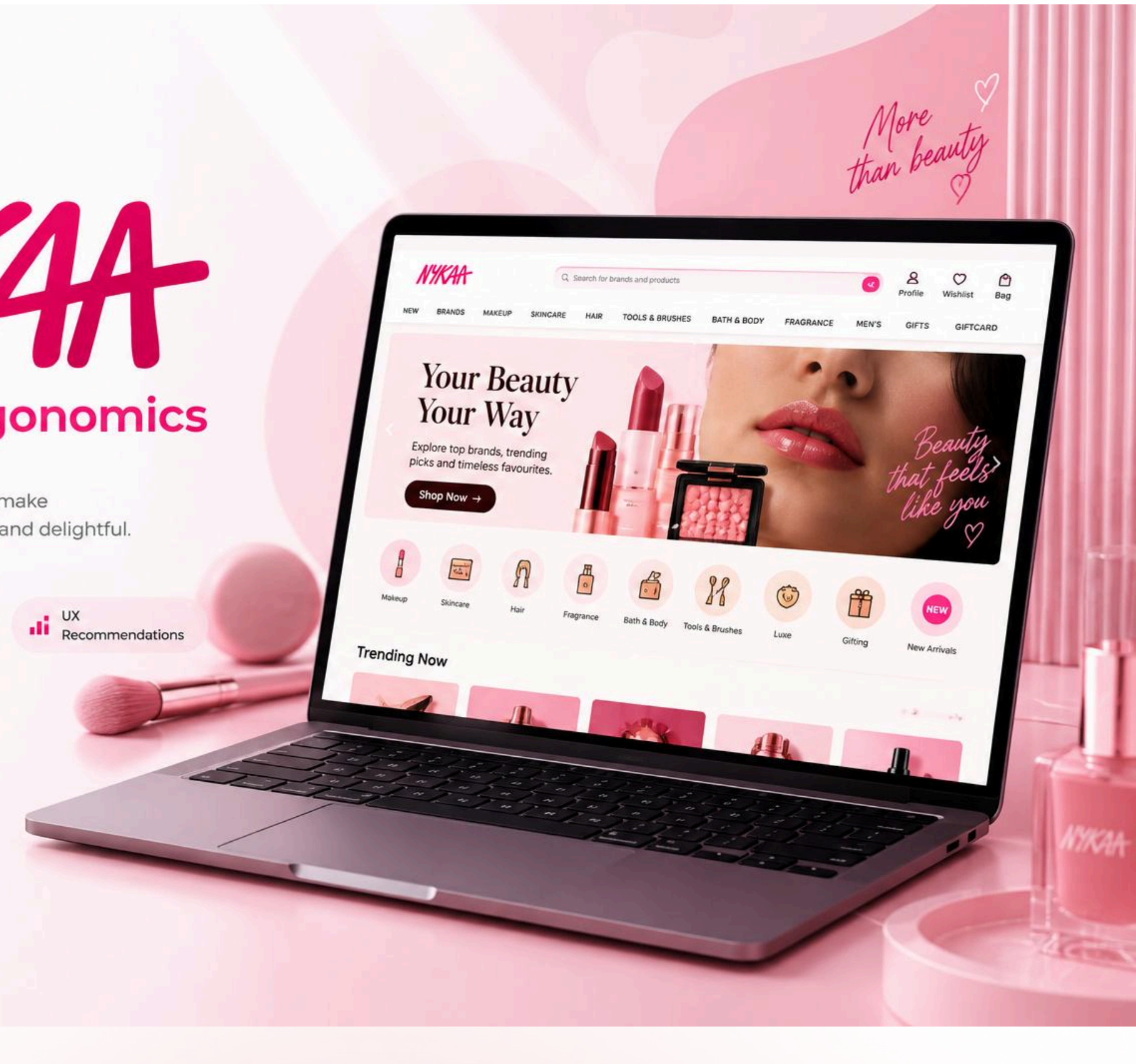
UX EVALUATION

NYKAA Cognitive Ergonomics

Analysing the web experience to make beauty more intuitive, accessible and delightful.

Heuristic Evaluation · Cognitive Ergonomics · UX Recommendations

Beauty for every you


More than beauty
NYKAA
Profile
Wishlist
Bag
NEW
BRANDS
MAKEUP
SKINCARE
HAIR
TOOLS & BRUSHES
BATH & BODY
FRAGRANCE
MEN'S
GIFTS
GIFTCARD
Your Beauty Your Way
Explore top brands, trending picks and timeless favourites.
Shop Now →
Beauty that feels like you
Makeup
Skincare
Hair
Fragrance
Bath & Body
Tools & Brushes
Luxe
Gifting
NEW
New Arrivals
Trending Now

Project Overview

Redesigning Nykaa's hidden gift card flow to cut cognitive effort and boost task efficiency.

Why Nykaa?

We selected Nykaa because its crowded homepage and complex filtering create visual friction and cognitive overload for new users.

Problem Statement

Nykaa's feature-dense homepage creates visual noise and decision fatigue, causing users to get lost when attempting straightforward tasks like buying a gift card.

Process

01 Hierarchical Task Analysis

02 Heuristic Evaluation

03 Useability Metrics

04 Nasa TLX

05 Hicks & Fitts Law

06 Cognitive Walkthrough

07 Redesign

HTA- Hierarchical Task Analysis

Step 1: Open App

Banner Overload: Promos hijack focus.
Missing Shortcut: No "Gifting" top-bar chip.

Step 2: Locating Entry Point (Major Friction)

Buried Location: Hidden in sub-menus.
No Visual Hierarchy: Lacks top-level anchors.
Forced Search: Relies on search, not scanning

Step 3: Card Selection

Hidden Inputs: Custom values below fold.
Low Contrast CTAs: Buttons blend into background.

Step 4: Checkout

Long Form: Single-page field fatigue.
No Preview: Lacks card confirmation step.

- Locating the gift card section is not visible, as it is buried in the menu.
- Users may struggle to find it without prior knowledge of its location.

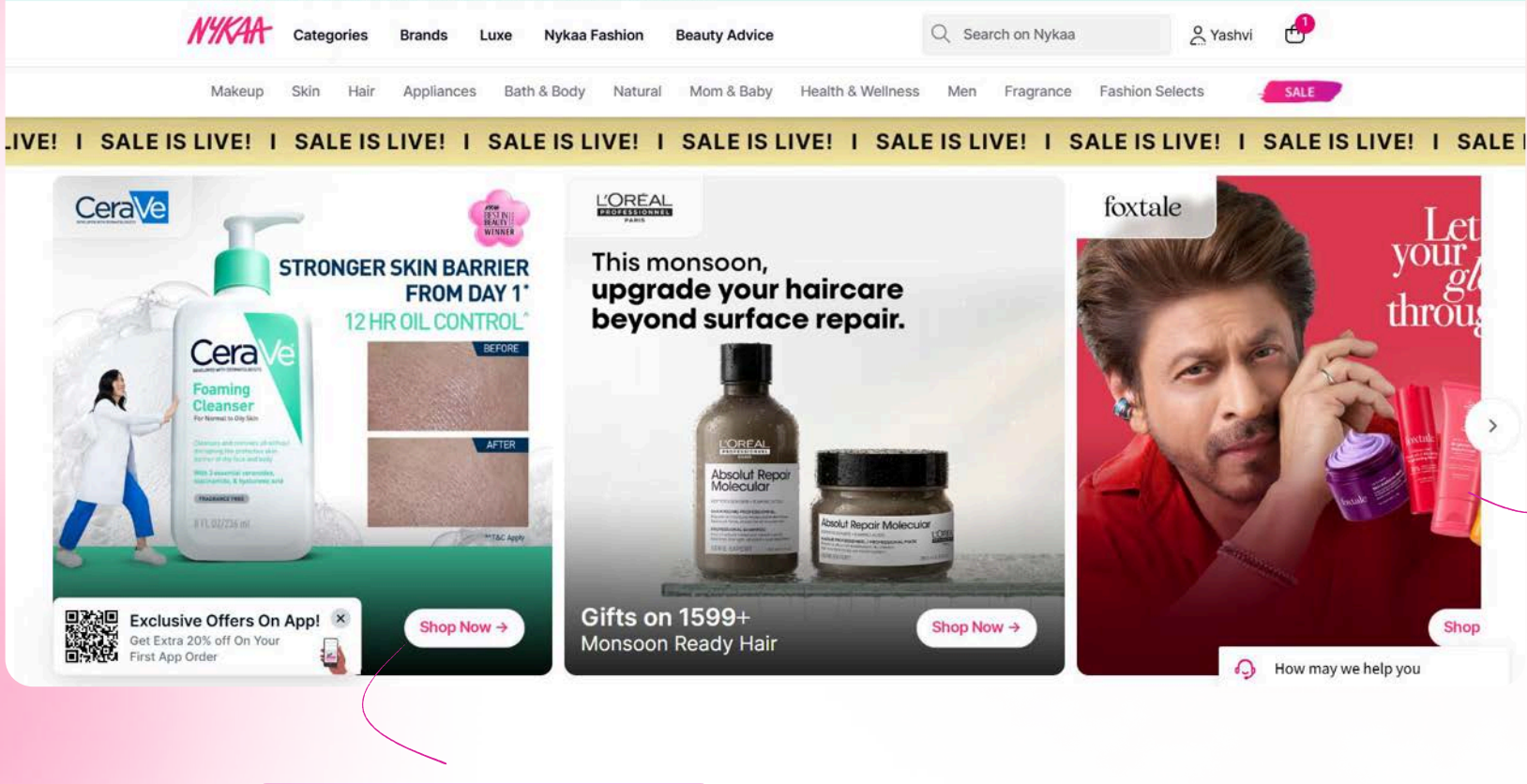
Heuristic Evaluation And Cognitive Walkthrough

- Cognitive Walkthrough (CW): Represents the horizontal step-by-step user journey (User Mindset & Actions).
- Heuristic Evaluation (HE): Represents the interface violation tags anchored to each step (System Rule Failures).

Lack Of Visual Anchor (CW)
First-time users find no obvious starting point for non-product purchasing.

Recognition (HE)
Gift Card" option is placed on the top utility strip with small text, no icon emphasis, no visual priority. Easy to miss on first visit.

Screen 1 Homepage


SUPREME STEALS AND STANDOUT OFFERS ARE HERE. SHOP NOW.
Get App
Store & Events
Gift Card
Help
NYKAA
Categories
Brands
Luxe
Nykaa Fashion
Beauty Advice
Search on Nykaa
Yashvi
Makeup
Skin
Hair
Appliances
Bath & Body
Natural
Mom & Baby
Health & Wellness
Men
Fragrance
Fashion Selects
SALE
SALE IS LIVE!
CeraVe
STRONGER SKIN BARRIER FROM DAY 1
12 HR OIL CONTROL
Exclusive Offers On App!
Shop Now →
L'OREAL
This monsoon, upgrade your haircare beyond surface repair.
Gifts on 1599+
Monsoon Ready Hair
foxtale
Shop
How may we help you

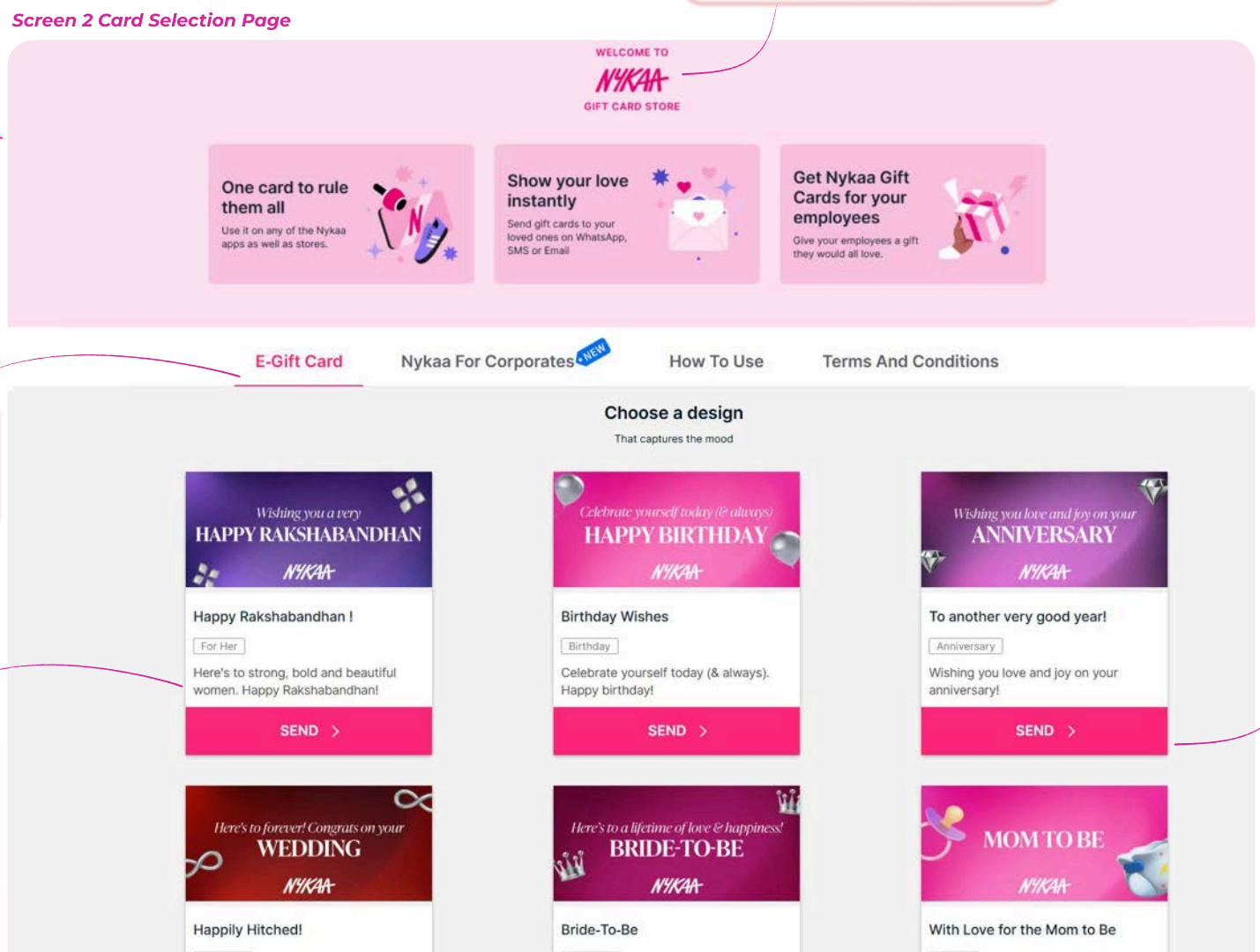
Visual Distraction (CW)
High promotional density hijacks initial focus away from the primary task.

Aesthetic & Minimalistic Design (HE)
Competing banners and visual noise overwhelm primary navigation elements.

Visual Hierarchy & Whitespace Balance (HE)
Massive pink banner at the top consumes unnecessary screen space, forcing primary content down.

Clear Visual Indication (CW)
The large "Nykaa Gift Card" banner makes it clear where the user has landed.

Screen 2 Card Selection Page


WELCOME TO
NYKAA
GIFT CARD STORE
One card to rule them all
Show your love instantly
Get Nykaa Gift Cards for your employees
E-Gift Card
Nykaa For Corporates
NEW
How To Use
Terms And Conditions
Choose a design
That captures the mood
HAPPY RAKSHABANDHAN
Happy Rakshabandhan !
HAPPY BIRTHDAY
Birthday Wishes
ANNIVERSARY
To another very good year!
SEND
WEDDING
Happily Hitched!
BRIDE-TO-BE
Bride-To-Be
MOM TO BE
With Love for the Mom to Be

No Search Bar (CW)
There is no filter or dropdown to choose by occasion or price.

Low Visual Engagement (CW)
Plain, text-heavy copy lacks visual hierarchy and discourages users from exploring further.

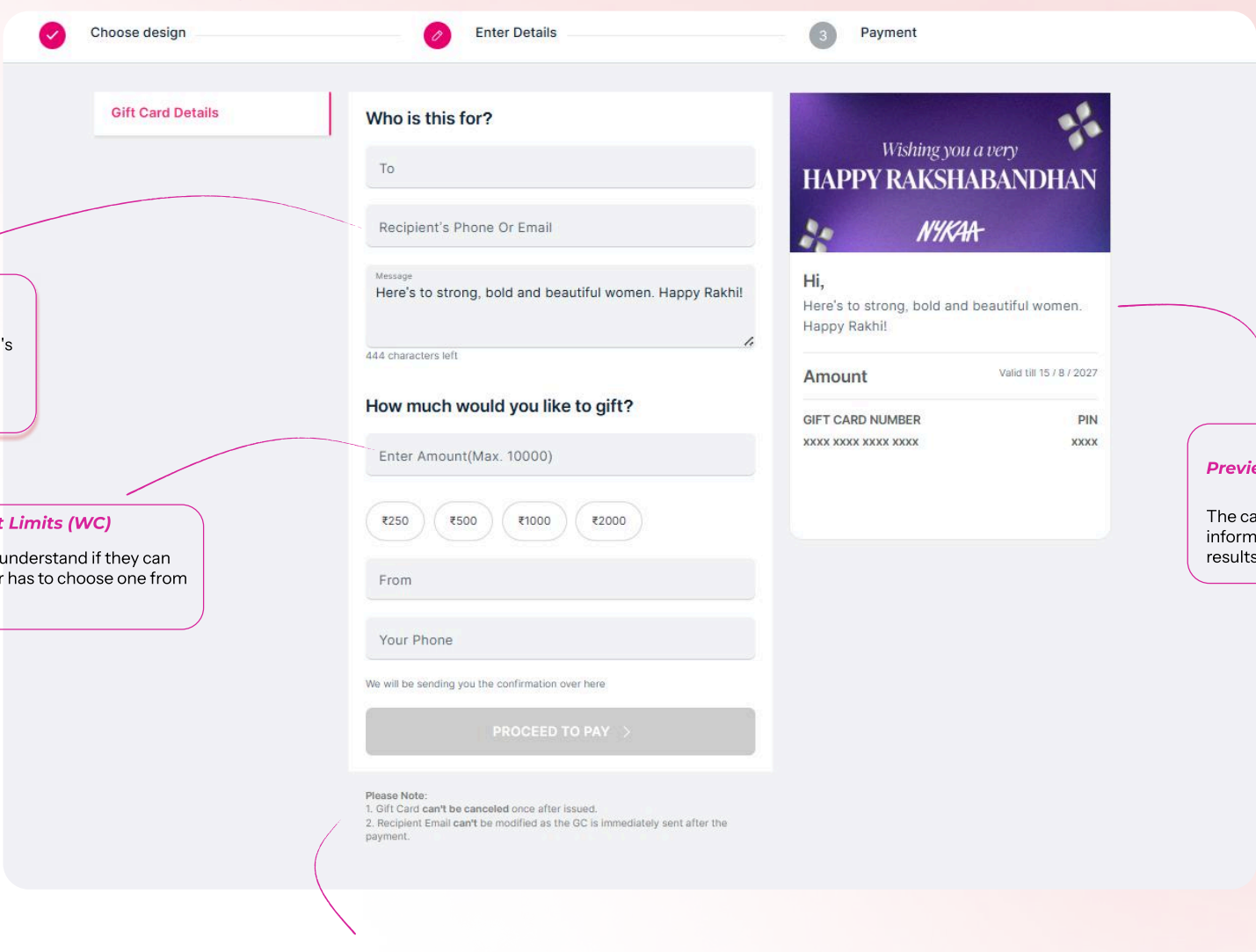
Match Between System And The Real World (HE)
The button text says "SEND ", which misleadingly implies sending the card immediately rather than advancing to the next step

Accessibility (HE)
Category tags (e.g., "For Her") and the card preview text use light grey fonts against a white background, making them hard to read at a glance.

Lack Of Emotional Resonance In Card Graphics (HE)
The gift card graphics feel flat and generic. They fail to convey warmth and celebration.

User Engagement (CW)
"There's nothing catching my eye." The interface lacks visual anchors to keep users engaged.

Screen 3 Card Details Page


Choose design
Enter Details
3
Payment
Gift Card Details
Who is this for?
To
Recipient's Phone Or Email
How much would you like to gift?
Enter Amount(Max. 10000)
₹250
₹500
₹1000
₹2000
From
Your Phone
PROCEED TO PAY
HAPPY RAKSHABANDHAN
Amount
GIFT CARD NUMBER
PIN

Message: Here's to strong, bold and beautiful women. Happy Rakhi!

Unclear Input Constraints (HE)
Single combined field for "Recipient's Phone Or Email" creates ambiguity regarding auto-validation rules and format requirements.

Ambiguous Input Limits (WC)
The users does not understand if they can input any amount or has to choose one from the options.

Preview Text Available (CW)
The card shows a preview after filling the information so that the users can see the results .

Error Prevention (HE)
Important policy notes at the bottom are written in tiny grey font, making critical constraints easy to miss.

Useability Metrics

- By tracking user speed, success rates, and satisfaction, we turned UX problems into clear numbers.
- This highlighted the biggest friction points so we knew exactly what needed fixing.

The task was given to 7 novice and 7 Expert users;
Users were timed while they were performing the task.

Effectiveness

100%

Purchasing a gift card achieved a perfect 100% completion rate across both novice and expert users. Users were able to complete the task seamlessly without encountering friction.

Overall Relative Efficiency In Time

48.8%

At 48.8% efficiency, buying a gift card takes longer than it should. Users get slowed down because the path isn't obvious and key buttons are hard to spot.

NASA TLX

Mental Demand

High — Low

Heavy visual scanning required to filter out unrelated promotions and banners.

Temporal Demand

High — Low

Navigational delays created perceived time pressure and disorientation.

Frustration Level

High — Low

Misleading nested menus led to repeated trial-and-error clicks.

Performance

High — Low

Tasks were eventually completed, but at the cost of high user strain.

Effort Expended

High — Low

Disproportionate cognitive energy spent locating a basic transaction flow.

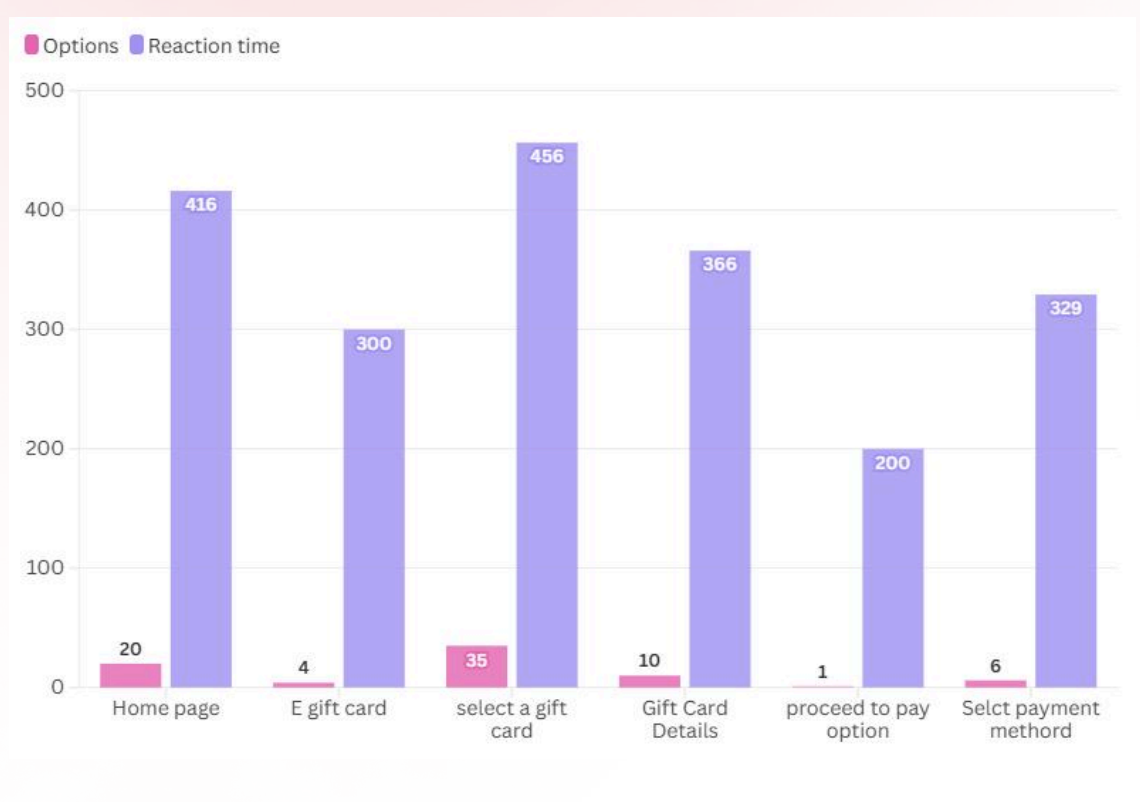
Physical Demand

High — Low

Standard mobile interaction; physical effort was minimal.

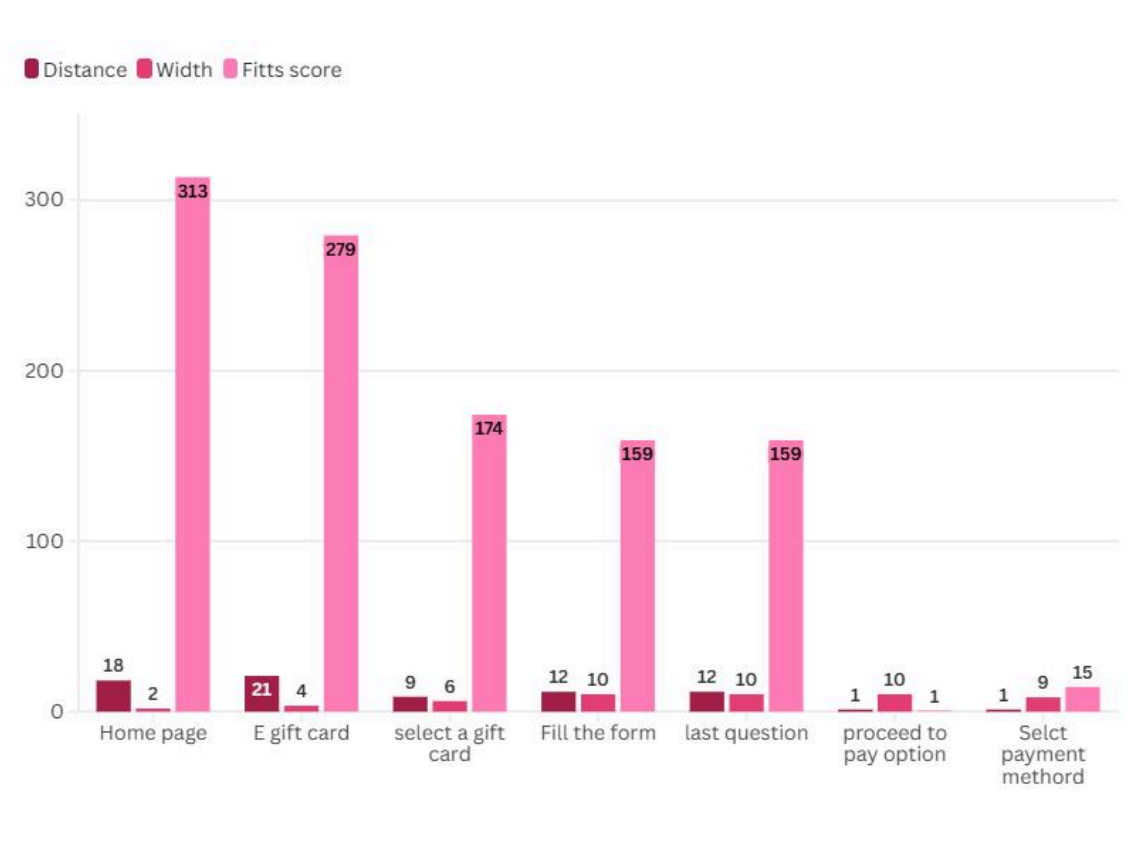
Fitts Law & Hick's Law

Hick's Law



- Worst Bottleneck: Select a Gift Card → 35 Options | 456s Reaction Time
- Initial Friction: Home Page → 20 Options | 416s Reaction Time
- Fastest Step: Proceed to Pay → 1 Option | 200s Reaction Time
- Takeaway: Cutting interface choices directly cuts decision latency by over 50%.

Fitts Law

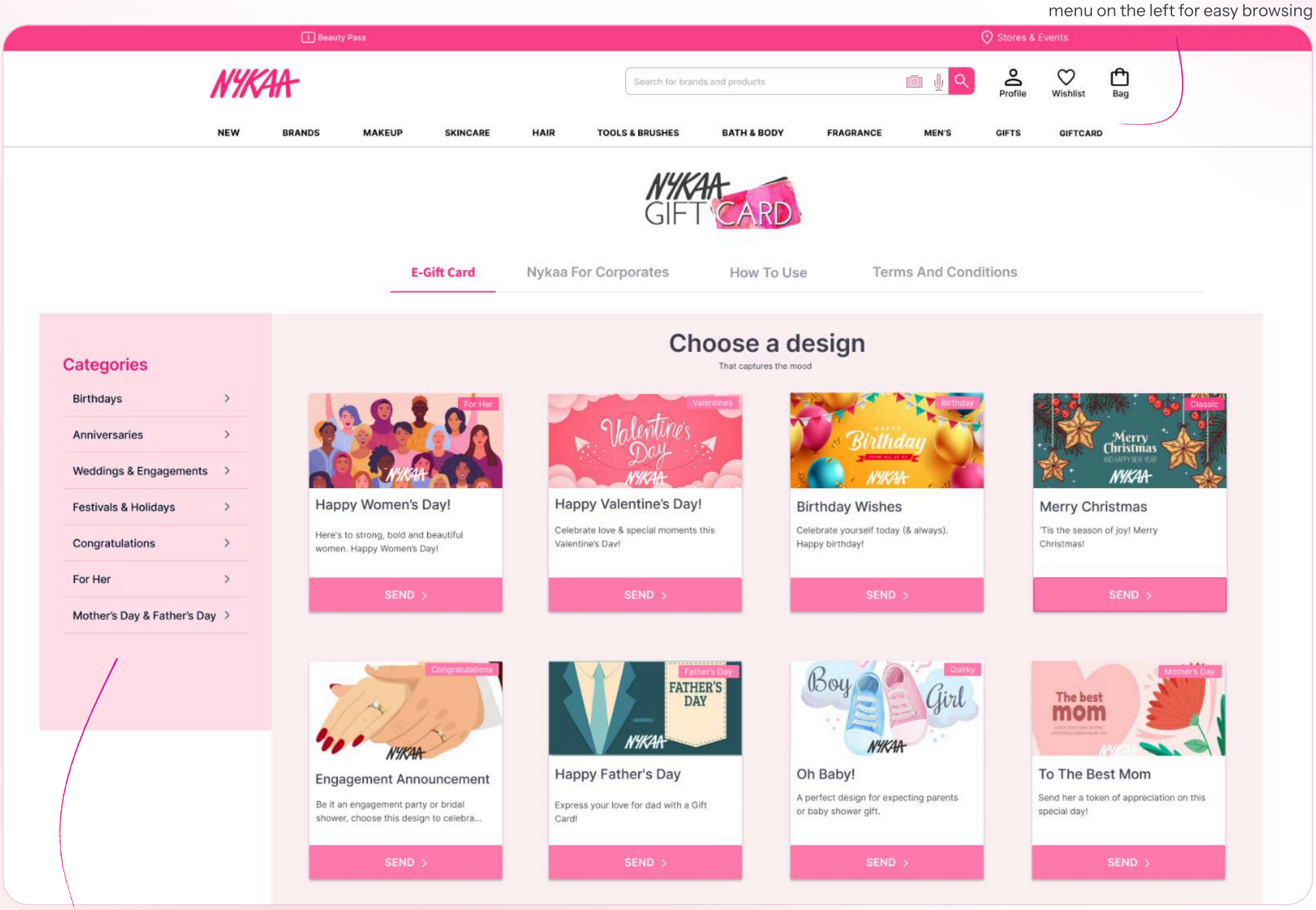


- Worst Target Ergonomics: Home Page → Width: 2 | Distance: 18 | Fitts Score: 313
- Longest Reach Distance: E-Gift Card → Distance: 21 | Fitts Score: 279
- Best Target Ergonomics: Proceed to Pay → Width: 10 | Distance: 1 | Fitts Score: 1
- Design Solution: Moving key actions to the bottom thumb zone and expanding target widths reduces targeting friction by over 99%.

Redesign

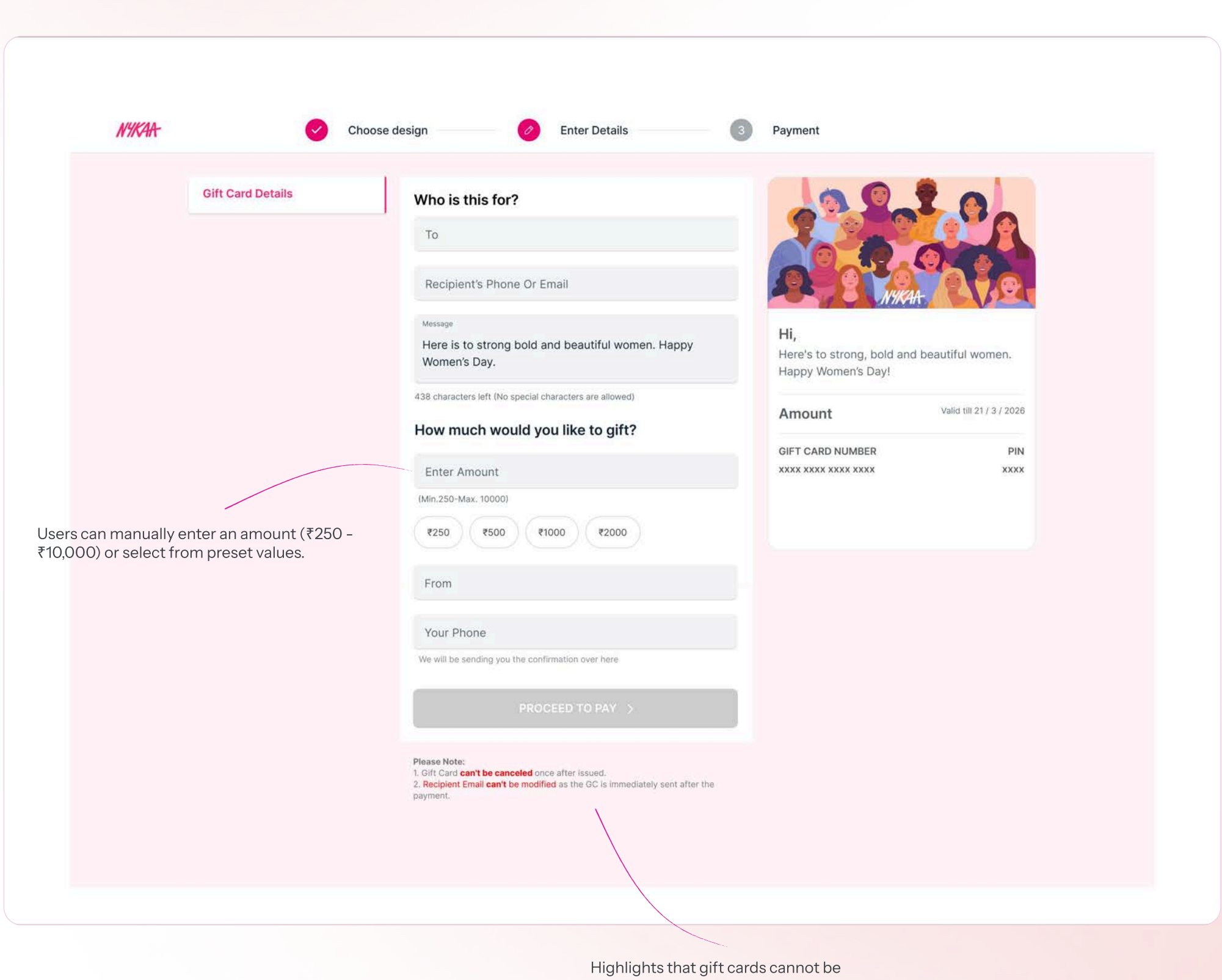
Redesigned the screens based on key usability issues identified, focusing on improving navigation, visibility, and efficiency. Elements like hidden icons, unclear categorization, and inefficient task flows were refined to create a more intuitive and seamless user experience.

A clear and structured category menu on the left for easy browsing


Beauty Pass
Stores & Events
NYKAA
Search for brands and products
Profile
Wishlist
Bag
NEW
BRANDS
MAKEUP
SKINCARE
HAIR
TOOLS & BRUSHES
BATH & BODY
FRAGRANCE
MEN'S
GIFTS
GIFTCARD
NYKAA GIFT CARD
E-Gift Card
Nykaa For Corporates
How To Use
Terms And Conditions
Categories
Birthdays
Anniversaries
Weddings & Engagements
Festivals & Holidays
Congratulations
For Her
Mother's Day & Father's Day
Choose a design
Happy Women's Day!
Happy Valentine's Day!
Birthday Wishes
Merry Christmas
Engagement Announcement
Happy Father's Day
Oh Baby!
To The Best Mom
SEND

The left-side category menu organizes gift card options based on different occasions, making it easier for users to find relevant designs.

A visually appealing card layout with different gifting occasions for quick selection.


NYKAA
Choose design
Enter Details
3
Payment
Gift Card Details
Who is this for?
To
Recipient's Phone Or Email
How much would you like to gift?
Enter Amount
(Min.250-Max. 10000)
₹250
₹500
₹1000
₹2000
From
Your Phone
PROCEED TO PAY
Amount
GIFT CARD NUMBER
PIN

Message: Here is to strong bold and beautiful women. Happy Women's Day.

Please Note:
1. Gift Card can't be canceled once after issued.
2. Recipient Email can't be modified as the GC is immediately sent after the payment.

Users can manually enter an amount (₹250 - ₹10,000) or select from preset values.

Highlights that gift cards cannot be canceled or modified after purchase.

Learning

- Learned how to identify cognitive overload and usability issues using different UX evaluation methods.
- Understood how HTA, Heuristic Evaluation, NASA-TLX, Fitts' Law, Hick's Law, and Cognitive Walkthroughs reveal different aspects of user experience.
- Learned that a task can have 100% completion but still be inefficient, as shown by the 48.8% time-efficiency result.
- Understood the importance of clear navigation, visual hierarchy, button visibility, and reducing unnecessary choices in e-commerce interfaces.
- Learned how research findings can be translated into practical redesign decisions.

Conclusion

The study showed that Nykaa's gift-card flow is successful but not efficient. While users were able to complete the task with a 100% success rate, unclear navigation, crowded choices, and low visibility of key elements increased effort and time. The redesign focused on making the flow clearer, more visible, and easier to navigate, creating a more intuitive user experience.

Thank You:)